

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, partly cloudy, an afternoon storm, high 75. **Tonight**, humid, cloudy, low 68. **Tomorrow**, a morning shower and an afternoon storm, high 86. Weather map, Page A16.

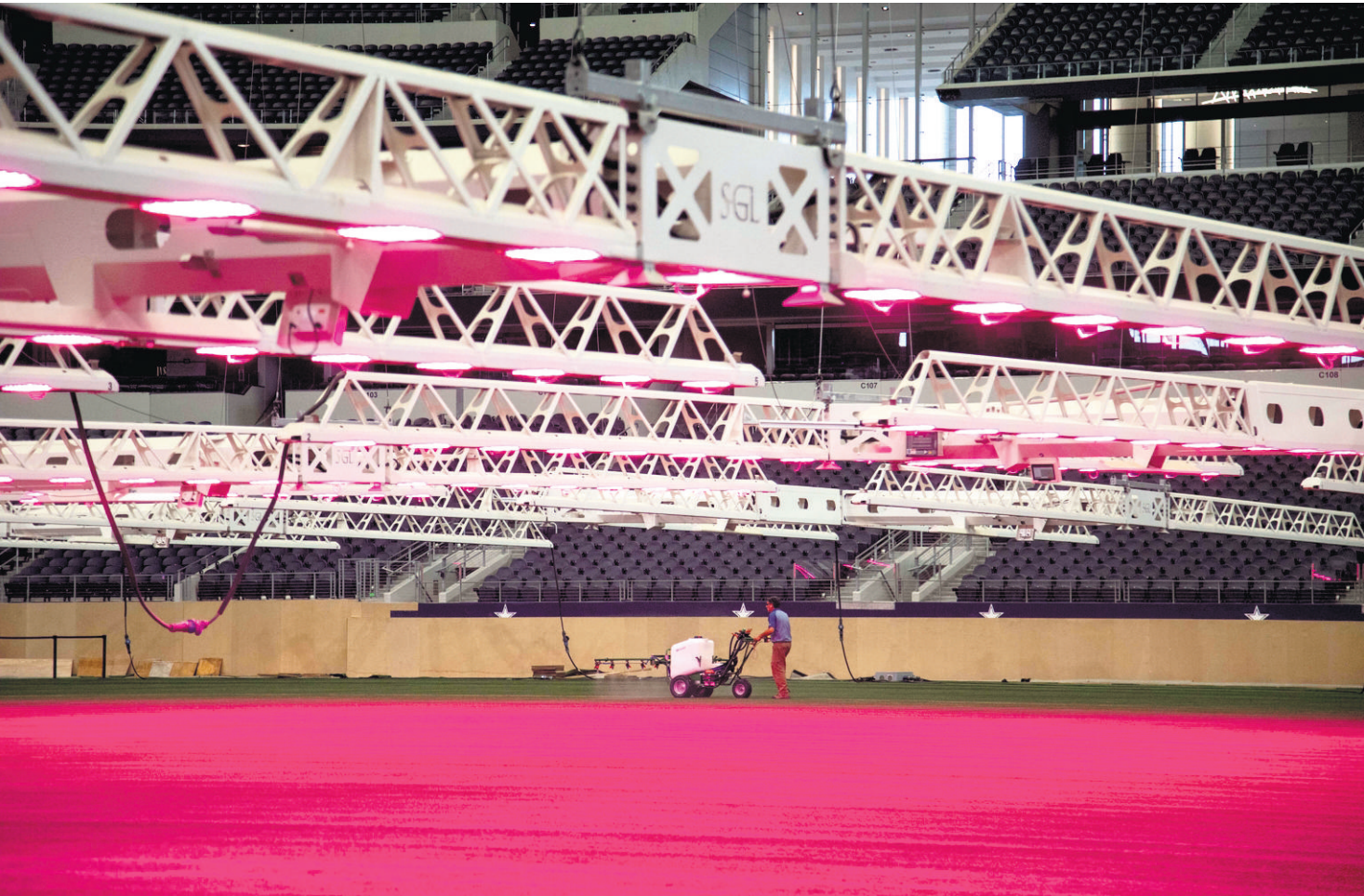
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Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00



DALLAS HOST COMMITTEE



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STEVEN BRIDGES/UNIVERSITY OF TENNESSEE

Clockwise from top: Using LED grow lights to help the turf thrive in Dallas Stadium; a roll of turf grass; getting ready at Dallas Stadium. Most venues are using a mix of Kentucky bluegrass and ryegrass, while Miami and Monterrey, Mexico, use Bermuda grass.

At World Cup, Science Crafts Perfect Fields

By ALAN BURDICK

As you settle in to watch the world’s biggest sporting event — 39 days, 48 teams, 104 matches and more than 1,200 pairs of pounding, cleated feet — spare a blessing for the grass.

FIFA, the international ruling body of soccer, mandates that every World Cup match be played on natural, living turf. Moreover, the playing experience, including the bounce and movement of the ball and the player “feel,” must be consistent from venue to venue. (Also, the field must be green.)

Achieving this is no small task. The 2026 World Cup involves 16 stadiums — five of them domed, eight with permanent artificial turf that must be overlaid — across three countries and widely varying climates.

“We have this massive, massive tournament footprint,” said Alan Ferguson, FIFA’s senior pitch management manager. “Trying to bring that together in a uniform manner has been our biggest challenge.”

Under Mr. Ferguson’s guidance, FIFA has assembled a crack team of turfologists led by John Sorochan at the University of Tennessee and John Rogers at Michigan State University. They have been working since 2018 to determine how best to achieve the green dream. Here’s where they have landed.

There are two dozen species of turf grass; none are created equal. Kentucky bluegrass is a cold-

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An Addictive Drug Has Allies in Trump’s Cabinet

By KENNETH P. VOGEL and CHRISTINA JEWETT

WASHINGTON — For years, federal health officials have warned about the risks associated with a supplement derived from the leaves of kratom trees that adherents say can kill pain or boost energy. Sold in gas stations across America, kratom has been linked to liver toxicity, seizures and thousands of deaths.

Powerful figures close to President Trump, including Homeland Security Secretary Markwayne Mullin, pushed to downplay those concerns.

Mr. Mullin, until recently a Republican senator from Oklahoma, played a key role in a sprawling influence campaign spearheaded by the kratom industry that courted Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. and Vice President JD Vance, among others in the Trump administration, an investigation by The New York Times found.

Only when he was nominated by Mr. Trump in March to lead the Homeland Security Department did it become clear that Mr. Mullin had a financial connection to the supplement. In a disclosure statement, he listed an investment worth as much as \$1 million in a kratom company, Botanic Tonics, that could benefit from the changes he has sought.

The company’s founder, Jerry W. Ross — who had been an energy executive in Mr. Mullin’s home state before pleading guilty to a financial crime — is a leading player in the influence campaign that was devised to benefit kratom at the expense of its rivals in the marketplace.

The kratom campaign under-

Mullin Holds a Stake in a Kratom Company

scores how corporations in the growing wellness industry can gain traction in Mr. Trump’s government by casting risky products as aligned with the administration’s Make America Healthy Again, or MAHA, agenda championed by Mr. Kennedy, who has sometimes prioritized unproven

remedies over science.

In July, while still a senator, Mr. Mullin showed up at a Food and Drug Administration news conference and endorsed proposed federal restrictions on more powerful synthetic supplements that compete with kratom for shelf space. In explaining his position, Mr. Mullin pointed to a history of addiction in his family, though health experts say kratom products have also been shown to be addictive.

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UNFORGETTABLE CHAMPIONS

As the city’s celebrations build to Thursday’s parade, relive the Knicks’ epic playoff run in a special section.

Deal Set to Open Strait, But New Hurdles Arise From Months of Closure

U.S. Navy to Deploy New Technology to Clear Mines

By JOHN ISMAY and NICHOLAS KULISH

The deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz has raised hopes that “oil will flow on both ends,” as President Trump said Sunday, quickly easing an impending energy crisis.

But it might not be that simple. To restart ship traffic in the strait, one of the most important questions will be whether the Iranians laid naval mines and, if so, how quickly they can be found and neutralized.

It is not even clear that the Iranians laid any mines at all; scores of ships have passed through the strait during the war without hitting mines. In March, United States Central Command said that it had attacked 16 Iranian mine-laying vessels near the Strait of Hormuz, but the impact of those efforts is uncertain.

On Monday, Mr. Trump said that the strait was “already partially opened” and that “they’re doing a little hunting for a couple of mines.”

He is also expected to ask European leaders to provide help clearing mines, saying it would not hurt to have “a ship or two up here from a few countries.”

Britain said last month that it could deploy mine-hunting drones as part of a multinational mission to secure the Strait of Hormuz.

On Monday, President Emmanuel Macron of France said that France was prepared to dispatch mine-clearing vessels within a few days of a confirmed peace deal.

Before the war began, United States intelligence agencies estimated that Iran had 5,000 mines of different kinds, from relatively crude varieties that float just beneath the surface to far more advanced weapons that sit on the seafloor and use a combination of sensors to find their targets.

To search out any mines that might be lurking in the Strait of Hormuz, the U.S. Navy will hunt from the air and sweep the sea, from the surface and deep underwater.

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NEWS ANALYSIS

Catalyzing Big Shift in Global Energy

By PATRICIA COHEN

LONDON — The framework deal between the United States and Iran sets the stage for an end to the bursts of violence and debilitating disruption of energy deliveries and trade in the Persian Gulf. But don’t expect economies around the globe to simply pick up where they left off before the United States and Israel began bombing Iran on Feb. 28.

The war has set in motion changes that will be hard to reverse.

The near shutdown in oil and natural gas deliveries from the Middle East and the leap in prices are causing a shift in power. Energy producers from the Gulf to the Americas are jockeying to maintain or increase their dominance, and customers are struggling to reduce their dependence and shore up their supply.

As a result, the energy market is changing, the energy mix is changing and the energy players are changing.

The profound vulnerability of countries throughout Asia, Europe and elsewhere that depend on imported energy is supercharging the hunt for alternatives. In some places, like South Korea and Japan, that has led to an increased use of dirtier fuels like coal.

But over the longer term, this

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DAVID GUTTENFELDER/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Destruction in Lebanon on Tuesday. The war has shaken any trust in Mideast stability.

For 250th, a Maritime Pageant Daunting in Hef and Hassles

By DANA RUBINSTEIN and JOHN ISMAY

As part of the nation’s 250th anniversary celebration, a startling nautical spectacle will soon take shape off the coast of New York City.

About 80 vessels — tall ships with white sails, some gray-hulled warships bristling with weapons, maybe even a 100,000-ton aircraft carrier — will tie up in and around New York Harbor. Nearly 200 military aircraft will be poised to fly overhead.

The stated purpose of this two-day extravaganza, set to begin July 3, is to celebrate the American colonies’ declaration of independence from King George III in 1776, by convening what organizers say will be the “largest maritime and aerial gathering in American history.”

The event, called Sail4th 250, is so intricately complicated that the commander of Coast Guard Sector New York, Capt. Jonathan Andrechik, a 26-year veteran who helped lead the rescue of 7,500 people in Texas during Hurricane Harvey, described it as “by far the most complex planned event I have ever been part of.”

“We’ve sort of run out of adjectives to describe the scale and scope of what we’re going to do here,” he said.

Numerous tabletop exercises have been played out to prepare for the countless eventualities that could derail the proceedings. The federal government is helping de-conflict radio signals, so the different law enforcement agencies involved will be able to talk to one another.

“We have put together this crisis management plan, and any-

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INTERNATIONAL A4-9	BUSINESS B1-6	ARTS C1-6	FOOD D1-8	OPINION A18-19
Trump-Modi Meeting at G7 Despite mutual praise between the two leaders, there has been a series of setbacks to U.S. relations with India since they met over a year ago. PAGE A8	Anticipation in ‘Elon Land’ Elon Musk’s companies have forever changed Bastrop, Texas, population 14,000. Its residents now wonder what SpaceX’s giant I.P.O. will mean. PAGE B1	A Mountainous Illusion A disciple of the conceptual artist Christo is draping the Pont Neuf, the oldest bridge in Paris, in acres of fabric, just as it was four decades ago. PAGE C1	Foolproofing Your Flapjacks Are the pancakes you make a little too flat? Too thick? Too spongy? Sometimes the biggest mistake is not what you did, but what you did not do. PAGE D7	Robinson Meyer PAGE A18



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